

THE HEARTBEAT OF INDIA'S MIDFIELD

In a career spanning over 400 matches, Manpreet Singh has been the **quiet constant** in Indian hockey's journey, linking eras with the same unhurried certainty he brings to the midfield.

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For nearly 15 years since his debut in 2011, Manpreet Singh has seen the mental battles athletes face — the creeping insecurities, the denial of fading abilities, and the whispers about relevance. "I want to give my 100 per cent every time I go on the ground; I don't want anyone to think that I am taking it easy," the 33-year-old former Indian captain tells *Sportstar*.

Despite winning numerous individual and team honours, including two Olympic bronze medals, four Asian Champions Trophy titles and two Asian Games golds, the midfielder still longs for the World Cup — a title India last claimed in 1975. "The next World Cup is my focus, and I'm desperate to earn a medal. It constantly motivates me to keep working harder," he says at the national camp in SAI Bengaluru, where Craig Fulton's

Decorated athlete: From the Arjuna Award in 2018 to being crowned the world's best men's player in 2019 and receiving the Khel Ratna in 2021, Manpreet Singh's career is studded with hockey's highest honours at both national and global levels. K MURALIKUMAR

DATA DRIBBLE
SENIOR INTERNATIONAL CAPS

402
Goals

44
First match

03/09/2011
Most recent match

22/06/2025

According to FIH